

PHONICS • FLUENCY • COMPREHENSION

THE READING PLAYBOOK

A STRATEGY GUIDE FOR ALL-STAR READERS



GRADES 3–8 | 100 PAGES

PRINT & GO

NO PREP

ANSWER KEY

**15 MINUTES A DAY • COACH-GUIDED LESSONS • READING
INTERVENTION**

THE READING PLAYBOOK

A STRATEGY GUIDE FOR ALL-STAR READERS



HEY, ALL-STAR! (THIS PAGE IS FOR YOU)

Welcome to the team! Even pros practice a little bit every day to get better — and that's exactly what this playbook is for. Fill out your Player Card below, then turn the page and let's get warmed up!

MY PLAYER CARD

All-Star Name: _____

Coach's Name: _____

Team Name: _____

Favorite Sport: _____

Season Start: _____

My Superpower: _____

My Reading Goal This Season:

Pre-Season Stats

Starting WPM: _____

Reading Level: _____

Fill this in after your Diagnostic on page 5!

YOUR SEASON: 100 PAGES • ABOUT 15 MINUTES A DAY

COACH'S NOTE (PARENTS & GUIDES)

Welcome to the team! This playbook is designed for you and your reader to tackle together, about 15 minutes a day. Your role is to coach, encourage, and practice alongside your MVP. You do not need a teaching degree to be successful here — every page includes a brief "Coach's Script" telling you exactly how to help your child step up to the plate and succeed. Let's play ball!

TURN THE PAGE — YOUR FIRST PRACTICE STARTS NOW! →



Your job is **not to read for your child** — it's to coach them through the hard parts. The **Pause, Prompt, Praise** method gives you a simple 3-step system for exactly what to do when your reader gets stuck. Follow these steps consistently and you'll build a reader who problem-solves independently, not one who waits to be rescued.

THE 3-STEP COACHING METHOD: PAUSE • PROMPT • PRAISE

1

PAUSE

When your reader struggles or makes an error, **wait 5 seconds before saying anything**. Silence is productive. Resist the urge to jump in — give them a chance to notice and fix their own mistake. Most self-corrections happen in this window.

2

PROMPT

If they don't self-correct, give a **hint — not the answer**. Point them toward the specific skill they need. Use the Prompt Menu below to find the right words for the situation. A good prompt builds a strategy they can reuse next time.

3

PRAISE

When they succeed — on their own *or* with a prompt — **name exactly what they did right**. Specific praise builds the habits that stick: *"You chunked that into syllables and blended them. That's the skill right there."*

PROMPT MENU — WHAT TO SAY IN THE MOMENT

WHEN YOUR READER...

SAY THIS (not "sound it out")

Skips over a word

"Go back and try that word."

Guesses from the first letter only

"Does that match all the letters in the word?"

Reads letter-by-letter instead of chunking

"Can you find a chunk inside that word?"

Mispronounces a vowel sound

"What type of syllable is that one?"

Gets stuck on a long word

"Scoop it into syllables, then blend them together."

Self-corrects without any help

"Nice catch — you fixed that one yourself!"

✗ **AVOID:** The phrase "Sound it out" is too vague and often frustrating for struggling readers. The Prompt Menu above gives you specific, skill-targeted language your reader can actually act on.

✓ **REMEMBER:** Your calm, specific coaching during the hard moments teaches more than any correct answer ever will. Every good prompt is a rep your reader gets to keep.



The Daily 15-Minute Session

YOUR GAME PLAN: HOW EACH 15-MINUTE SESSION WORKS

1

2–3 MIN

WARM UP

Review the skill from yesterday. A quick "Can you remember...?" keeps it fresh.

Don't skip this—repetition is how new skills stick.

2

5–6 MIN

TEACH

Show the new skill. Read the Coach's Script on each page—it tells you exactly what to say.

Model it first; let your reader try second.

3

5–6 MIN

PRACTICE

Your reader does the exercises. You coach using Pause, Prompt, Praise. Celebrate every attempt.

Quality beats perfection. One page done is a win.

4

2–3 MIN

REFLECT

Ask: "What did you get better at today?" Celebrate growth, not grades.

This builds a reader who can self-assess.

EACH SECTION: WHAT YOUR ALL-STAR WILL MASTER

1

Cracking the Code

Phonics: vowels, syllables, blends, bigger words

2

Word Power

Morphology: prefixes, suffixes, roots

3

Smooth Sailing

Fluency: reading with expression and speed

4

Thinking Deeply

Comprehension: main idea, inference, summary

5

Application

Using all skills to read harder, longer texts

✓ SIGNS OF PROGRESS — LOOK FOR THESE

- ☐ Breaks long words into syllables without prompting
- ☐ Stops to self-correct when something doesn't sound right
- ☐ Reads with better expression and fewer pauses
- ☐ Can retell what they read in their own words



Diagnostic Pre-Test Part 1

COACH'S NOTE: This quick test helps you see where your All-Star stands before you start. No pressure—it's not graded. Just read each word aloud and mark what you hear. If they skip or get stuck, mark it. Move on—don't drill it right now. You'll work on these skills throughout the playbook.

PART 1: PHONICS WORD LIST

Read each word aloud. Mark ✓ for correct, or mark the error (skip, guess, wrong sound). Start with easier words; build to harder ones.

WORD	✓ CORRECT	ERROR / NOTES
cat	☐	☐
make	☐	☐
stop	☐	☐
string	☐	☐
shake	☐	☐
button	☐	☐
elephant	☐	☐
magnificent	☐	☐
responsibility	☐	☐
chunk	☐	☐
sprinkle	☐	☐
dolphin	☐	☐
celebrate	☐	☐
independent	☐	☐

Score: ____ / 14 words correct

COACH'S QUICK NOTES

Where did it get hard? (short words / long words / blends) _____

A pattern to watch for this season: _____



Coach's Note: This is your baseline. Don't worry if it's slow—that's exactly why we're starting here. By page 100, your All-Star will be faster, smoother, and more confident. Keep this score and watch the progress!

PART 2: FLUENCY PASSAGE (100 WORDS)**The Training Camp**

Sarah loved soccer more than anything. Every Saturday, she went to training camp. At camp, Coach Mike taught the team new moves. They practiced passing, shooting, and defending. Sarah's best friend Maya was on the team too. Together, they worked hard and had lots of fun. One day, Coach Mike showed them a trick play. It was tricky at first, but Sarah kept trying. Soon, she got it! When the team won their first game, Sarah felt so proud. She and Maya cheered and danced. Every player worked as a team, and that's what made them strong. Sarah couldn't wait for next Saturday.

Instructions: Have your All-Star read the passage aloud while you time them. Mark any errors. Record their results below.

RECORDING FLUENCY DATA**Cold Read Time (sec):**

Errors on Cold Read:

Words Per Minute (WPM):

How to calculate WPM: $(100 \text{ words} \div \text{time in seconds}) \times 60 = \text{WPM}$

COACH'S OBSERVATION NOTES

Jot down what you noticed during the read — it will guide where to focus first.

Words that were tricky: _____

Did they read smoothly or word-by-word? _____

One strength I noticed: _____

One skill to work on: _____



FRONT MATTER

Progress Tracker & Roadmap

Watch your progress grow! As you finish each section, check it off. The 5 sections build on each other—by section 5, your All-Star will use every skill you've learned to tackle harder, longer texts.

THE 5-SECTION ROADMAP

Section 1: Cracking the Code	Pages 7–28	☐ Done	____ / 22
Section 2: Word Power	Pages 29–48	☐ Done	____ / 20
Section 3: Smooth Sailing	Pages 49–68	☐ Done	____ / 20
Section 4: Thinking Deeply	Pages 69–88	☐ Done	____ / 20
Section 5: Application	Pages 89–100	☐ Done	____ / 12

CELEBRATION MILESTONES

After Section 1: Your All-Star can now break big words into syllables. Celebrate by having them read a chapter from their favorite book!

After Section 2: They're building vocabulary power. Try a word hunt in a magazine or newspaper together.

After Section 3: Reading feels smoother and sounds more natural. Record them reading and play it back—watch them smile at their own progress!

After Section 4: They're thinking deeply about what they read. Ask them to tell you the story in their own words.

After Section 5: CHAMPION READER! Certificate of Achievement on page 100. This one's for framing.

MY SEASON GOALS

Before you start, set your goals for the season. Read them again at the end and see how far you came!

One reading skill I want to get better at: _____

A book or kind of book I want to be able to read: _____

How many pages will I try to do each week? _____

When I finish, I will celebrate by: _____



CRACKING THE CODE

ADVANCED PHONICS • PAGES 7–28

YOUR LINEUP FOR THIS SECTION

- | | | |
|---|----------------------------------|-------------|
| 1 | Vowel Consolidation | Pages 7–10 |
| 2 | The Six Syllable Types | Pages 11–14 |
| 3 | Vowel Teams & R-Controlled | Pages 15–18 |
| 4 | Consonant-LE & Syllable Division | Pages 19–22 |
| 5 | Multisyllabic Word Mastery | Pages 23–28 |

COACH'S HUDDLE

In this section, your All-Star learns to break big, intimidating words into bite-sized syllable chunks — one of the most powerful decoding skills for older readers. Some words will feel like a real workout at first. That's the point! Keep using **Pause, Prompt, Praise**, and remind your reader: every pro started out as a rookie.

WARM-UP CHALLENGE

Before you start, try this with your Coach: Say your full name out loud, one syllable at a time, clapping on each part. (Example: *Le-Bron James* = 3 claps!)

How many syllables are in **your** name? _____

Now try a friend's name or your favorite player's name. How many syllables? _____

**COACH'S SCRIPT**

Read each word aloud together. Ask your All-Star: "Do you hear a **SHORT** vowel sound, like the **a** in **cat** — or a **LONG** vowel sound, like the **a** in **cake**?" Remember the routine: **Pause** to give them time to try, **Prompt** with a hint if they're stuck, and **Praise** the effort — not just the right answer.

WORD BANK

Read each word below. Then write it in the correct dugout...

strand

gleam

plop

stripe

crop

throat

twitch

blaze

grasp

sweet

SORT THE WORDS: SHORT VOWEL OR LONG VOWEL?**SHORT VOWEL DUGOUT**

LONG VOWEL DUGOUT

WRITE YOUR OWN

Pick one word from each dugout. Use each word in its own sentence.

BONUS: BLEND & DIGRAPH SPOTLIGHT

Every word in the Word Bank starts with a consonant blend or digraph — two or three letters that blend together, like **str**, **gl**, **thr**, and **tw**. Go back and circle the blend at the start of each word.

**COACH'S SCRIPT**

Now your All-Star sorts these words independently. Let them write the words in the columns. This time, you're coaching from the sideline—ask guiding questions instead of giving answers.

PRACTICE SET 2: MORE WORDS TO SORT

Read, sort, and write these words in the correct column:

Words: flame, snap, slide, split, drove, print, broke, stuck

SHORT VOWEL

LONG VOWEL

REFLECTION

Look at your sorted words. What pattern do you notice? (Hint: Think about the vowel sounds...)

Coach's Tip: If your All-Star struggles, go back and listen together. Sometimes hearing the difference is easier than explaining it. Celebrate every correct sort!

✂ BONUS REP — True or False? Fix the False Ones

Read each statement. Write **T** or **F**. If it is false, fix it!

1. The word **cape** has a short vowel sound. ____
2. The word **flag** has a short vowel sound. ____
3. The word **those** has a long vowel sound. ____

**QUICK REVIEW: DO YOU REMEMBER?**

Match each word to its vowel sound. Write S (short) or L (long) next to each:

 map rake sit mice cup tune**LISTEN & SORT**

Your Coach will say these words aloud. Write them in the correct column:

SHORT VOWELS

LONG VOWELS

COACH'S CHALLENGE

Can you find a word from a book or magazine that has a short vowel sound? Write it here: _____

Now find one with a long vowel sound: _____

All-Star Note: Great work on Vowel Consolidation! You're ready to move forward. Next: The Six Syllable Types. You've got this!

✂ BONUS REP — Odd One Out

Circle the word whose vowel sound does not match the other three.

1. cat map cake bag

2. bike kite pin ride



The Six Syllable Types

KNOW THE PLAY

A **syllable** is a word part with one vowel sound. Every syllable in English is one of **six types** — we remember them with the word **CLOVER**. Learn the six and you can crack almost any word.

COACH'S SCRIPT

Big words aren't scary once you know the syllable types. There are six patterns that show up in almost every word. Learn these, and your All-Star can decode words they've never seen before. This is the secret weapon.

THE PLAY: CLOVER ACRONYM

Six syllable types hidden in the acronym **CLOVER**. Every syllable in English is one of these six. Master CLOVER, master multisyllabic words.

C**Closed**

Ends with consonant. Vowel is short.

cat, sit, fun

L**Open**

Ends with vowel. Vowel is long.

go, be, see

O**Vowel Team**

Two vowels together make one sound.

boat, rain, bread

V**R-Controlled**

Vowel + r makes special sound.

car, bird, fire

E**Consonant-LE**

Consonant before -LE is its own syllable.

table, bundle, apple

R**Silent E**

E at end makes vowel long.

cake, bike, make

TRY IT: SPOT THE SYLLABLE TYPE

Look at these words. Which CLOVER type is each one?

cap = ____ (C, L, O, V, E, or R?)

make = ____

train = ____

bird = ____

✂ BONUS REP — Find the Mistake

A rookie labeled these wrong. Cross out the wrong type and write the correct CLOVER type.

1. **cake** → labeled "Closed" → correct: ____

2. **car** → labeled "Open" → correct: ____



Six Syllable Types Practice

COACH'S SCRIPT

Now your All-Star identifies which syllable type is in each word. Read the word aloud together, then circle the right answer.

PRACTICE: IDENTIFY THE SYLLABLE TYPE

Read each word. Circle which type it is:

1. **dog** — Closed / Open / Vowel Team / R-Controlled / Consonant-LE / Silent E
2. **face** — Closed / Open / Vowel Team / R-Controlled / Consonant-LE / Silent E
3. **patio** — Closed / Open / Vowel Team / R-Controlled / Consonant-LE / Silent E
4. **car** — Closed / Open / Vowel Team / R-Controlled / Consonant-LE / Silent E
5. **table** — Closed / Open / Vowel Team / R-Controlled / Consonant-LE / Silent E
6. **boat** — Closed / Open / Vowel Team / R-Controlled / Consonant-LE / Silent E

WRITE YOUR OWN EXAMPLES

Can you think of a word for each type?

Closed word: _____

Open word: _____

MY GAME RECAP

In your own words, what did you practice on this page?



Syllable Types Practice Continued

COACH'S SCRIPT

More practice with CLOVER. Your All-Star is building automaticity—the more they see these patterns, the faster they'll recognize them.

MATCHING: WORD TO TYPE

Draw a line to match each word to its syllable type:

Words:

- tree
- smile
- tumble
- spell

Types:

- Vowel Team
- Silent E
- Consonant-LE
- Closed

SORT BY SYLLABLE TYPE

CLOSED OR OPEN?

BONUS REP — Odd One Out

Three words share a syllable type. Circle the one that does not.

1. **table** **apple** **bundle** **rain**

2. **car** **bird** **corn** **cake**

MY GAME RECAP

What was the trickiest part, and how did you work through it?



Six Syllable Types Review

QUICK REVIEW: CLOVER CHECK

Can you identify all six? Test yourself:

1. **cat** = _____
2. **me** = _____
3. **rain** = _____
4. **dark** = _____
5. **simple** = _____
6. **hope** = _____

CHALLENGE: BUILD YOUR OWN CLOVER WALL

Pick one word from your reading today. Write it below. Which CLOVER type is it?

Word: _____

CLOVER type: _____

All-Star Note: You've mastered CLOVER! These six types unlock big words. Next lesson: breaking multi-syllable words into chunks.

WORD SEARCH CHALLENGE

Find and circle these words (across, down, and diagonal):

Syllable • Closed • Silent • Vowel • Bossy • Open • Team

O	G	M	J	A	L	N	F	E	I	C	K
P	J	T	S	A	T	V	W	K	C	J	L
E	J	P	W	S	Y	K	F	P	P	W	T
N	F	B	I	S	Y	A	X	L	M	A	E
R	Z	N	S	L	M	L	S	A	O	B	A
C	W	O	F	T	G	D	L	Y	H	O	M
L	B	L	Q	L	Q	T	I	A	Y	O	D
O	S	X	Y	Z	N	L	J	B	B	N	C
S	G	K	Q	E	T	L	E	K	I	L	W
E	R	C	L	J	V	K	J	F	Z	C	E
D	U	I	E	X	W	J	P	F	X	B	C
T	S	R	V	O	W	E	L	M	B	H	X

MY GAME RECAP

Explain today's skill to your Coach as if they were a teammate:

**KNOW THE PLAY**

A **vowel team** is two vowels working together to make one sound, like *ai* in **rain**. An **R-controlled vowel** is a vowel bossed by the letter R, like *ar* in **car**.

COACH'S SCRIPT

Two vowels together don't always make two sounds—they often "team up" to make one sound. And the letter R is a bully: it bosses the vowel before it. Let's learn both.

VOWEL TEAMS: TWO VOWELS, ONE SOUND

When vowels sit next to each other, they often make one sound:

- ai** = long a sound (rain, train, paint)
- ea** = long e sound (beach, read, dream)
- oa** = long o sound (boat, coat, road)
- oo** = two sounds (moon, boot OR book, look)
- ou** = "ow" sound (house, mouse, cloud)

R-CONTROLLED VOWELS: THE BOSSY R

When R comes after a vowel, it changes the vowel sound completely:

- ar** = "ar" sound (car, dark, park)
- er** = "ur" sound (her, verb, perfect)
- ir** = "ur" sound (bird, shirt, first)
- or** = "or" sound (for, horn, sport)
- ur** = "ur" sound (turn, burst, turtle)

MY GAME RECAP

Give one example of how you could use this skill in a real book:

**COACH'S SCRIPT**

Listen carefully to the vowel sound in each word. Which team made that sound? Hearing the difference is the first step to reading it correctly.

PRACTICE: SPOT THE VOWEL TEAM

Circle the vowel team in each word:

1. rain — which team? (ai, ea, oa, oo, ou)
2. beach — which team? (ai, ea, oa, oo, ou)
3. cloud — which team? (ai, ea, oa, oo, ou)
4. toast — which team? (ai, ea, oa, oo, ou)
5. moon — which team? (ai, ea, oa, oo, ou)

FIND & WRITE VOWEL TEAM WORDS

Write one word for each vowel team:

ai word: _____

ea word: _____

ou word: _____

✂ BONUS REP — Find the Mistake

Each word is sorted into the wrong vowel-team group. Write the correct team.

1. boat → put in the "ai" group → correct: _____
2. dream → put in the "oa" group → correct: _____

MY GAME RECAP

What is one thing you understand now that you did not before?

**COACH'S SCRIPT**

The R changes everything. These words might look different, but listen: they all have that "controlled" sound because of the R.

PRACTICE: R-CONTROLLED VOWELS

Match each word to its R-controlled sound:

Words:

- car
- bird
- corn
- turn

Sounds:

- _____ ar (car)
- _____ ur (turn)
- _____ or (corn)
- _____ ir (bird)

LISTEN & SORT**ar (car)**

or (corn)

✂ BONUS REP — True or False? Fix the False Ones

Write **T** or **F**. Fix any that are false.

1. The ar in star says "ar". _____
2. The or in corn says "ur". _____

MY GAME RECAP

Write one question you still have about this skill:



Vowel Teams & R-Controlled Review

REVIEW: TEAMS & BOSSY R

Are these vowels teaming up or is R in charge?

1. **mail** — Team or R? _____
2. **shirt** — Team or R? _____
3. **boat** — Team or R? _____
4. **star** — Team or R? _____

WORD HUNT FROM YOUR READING

Find one word from today's reading for each type:

Vowel Team word: _____

R-Controlled word: _____

Coach Note: Your All-Star now knows CLOVER, teams, and bossy R. These are the building blocks for cracking any word!

WORD SEARCH CHALLENGE

Find and circle these words (across, down, and diagonal):

Beach • Cloud • Rain • Boat • Moon • Bird • Corn • Car

R	N	Y	K	N	O	S	O	R	L	J	H
Z	C	L	O	U	D	F	W	Y	A	H	C
S	J	O	Q	P	K	B	X	O	J	I	T
C	M	D	Q	N	F	Y	E	K	E	P	N
N	B	V	C	Y	R	S	Z	A	K	K	W
L	C	T	P	S	Z	O	C	C	C	I	P
W	O	V	C	T	B	X	W	J	U	H	S
V	R	O	A	J	W	M	V	L	A	C	O
L	N	O	F	T	D	P	B	G	Y	A	J
E	B	X	H	B	I	R	D	M	M	R	P
C	F	O	M	R	I	E	N	R	I	W	N
L	V	M	H	E	C	F	E	H	V	H	A

MY GAME RECAP

Rate this page 1-5 stars and tell why:



Consonant-LE Introduction

KNOW THE PLAY

A **Consonant-LE** syllable is a consonant + /e at the end of a word, like the **-ble** in **table**. That ending grabs the consonant and makes its own syllable.

COACH'S SCRIPT

Here's a tricky syllable type: consonant + LE. When you see a word ending in consonant + LE, that consonant gets its own syllable. This is the key to syllable scooping.

THE PATTERN: CONSONANT + LE

When you see **consonant + LE**, that consonant starts a new syllable:

table = ta + ble (2 syllables)

simple = sim + ple (2 syllables)

jungle = jun + gle (2 syllables)

apple = ap + ple (2 syllables)

PRACTICE: SYLLABLE SCOOPING

"Scoop" these words (draw a line between syllables):

1. **bottle**
2. **trouble**
3. **puzzle**
4. **marble**

FIND YOUR OWN -LE WORDS

Write three words that end in consonant + LE:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

✂ BONUS REP — Odd One Out

Circle the word that does NOT end in a Consonant-LE syllable.

1. **little** **apple** **happy** **table**

**COACH'S SCRIPT**

Mastering consonant-LE is a big deal. It means your All-Star can now break apart words like "basketball" or "terrible" by spotting that -LE pattern!

PRACTICE: -LE WORD SORTING

Do these words have consonant + LE? Circle YES or NO:

1. **able** — YES / NO
2. **maple** — YES / NO
3. **blue** — YES / NO
4. **needle** — YES / NO
5. **uncle** — YES / NO
6. **little** — YES / NO

SCOOP AND READ

Scoop these words, then read them aloud:

f a b l e

t u m b l e

b u m b l e

All-Star Achievement: You've mastered CLOVER, vowel teams, R-controlled, and consonant-LE. You're ready for multisyllabic words!

✂ BONUS REP — Find the Mistake

A rookie scooped these wrong. Re-scoop them correctly.

1. **ta·bl·e** → _____
2. **bun·d·le** → _____

MY GAME RECAP

What is one word or example from this page you want to remember?

**KNOW THE PLAY**

When two consonants sit between two vowels (the **VC/CV pattern**, like **nap·kin**), you usually split right between them. This is how you scoop a word into syllables.

COACH'S SCRIPT

Time to use the scoop. When two consonants sit between two vowels (the VC/CV pattern), we usually split right between them. Have your All-Star read each word, draw a scoop under each syllable, then blend the chunks back together.

SCOOP IT: SPLIT BETWEEN THE CONSONANTS

Draw a line between the two middle consonants, then read each chunk. The first one is done for you.

1. **nap·kin** (nap / kin)

2. **bas ket** → _____

3. **rab bit** → _____

4. **sud den** → _____

5. **mag net** → _____

6. **con test** → _____

WRITE YOUR OWN

Find two VC/CV words of your own and scoop them into syllables:

MY GAME RECAP

How would you teach this skill to a younger player?

**Consonant-LE & Syllable Division Review****COACH'S SCRIPT**

This is a quick check, not a test to fear. Let your All-Star try each item on their own first, then talk through any tricky ones together. The answer key is in the back of the book on page 99.

SKILL ASSESSMENT

Show what you know:

1. The word **table** ends in a Consonant-LE syllable. Circle that syllable: ta ble tab
2. Scoop **little** into two syllables: _____
3. Split **jungle** between the consonants and write the two parts: _____
4. Which word has a Consonant-LE syllable? (a) garden (b) purple (c) summer

SELF-REFLECTION

What got easier for you in this section? _____

Answers are in the Answer Key on page 99.

WORD SEARCH CHALLENGE

Find and circle these words (across, down, and diagonal):

Bundle • Jungle • Little • Table • Apple • Scoop

M	Z	X	D	J	G	T	V	H	X	Z	N
C	J	Y	I	G	M	I	A	K	Z	B	S
G	W	U	A	N	B	M	P	B	E	A	C
H	N	X	N	D	T	A	D	Y	L	S	O
G	G	K	A	G	E	C	E	E	R	E	O
A	Q	C	S	L	L	L	P	R	G	N	P
C	M	G	T	U	D	E	Y	C	W	S	E
F	T	T	X	N	B	B	I	R	V	T	A
E	I	X	U	I	X	S	B	D	W	M	P
L	H	B	F	T	Q	B	X	L	V	Q	P
S	S	Y	W	C	L	D	S	L	O	G	L
M	G	S	X	A	M	Z	T	K	A	N	E

MY GAME RECAP

What is your next goal for this skill?



Multisyllabic Word Mastery Intro

KNOW THE PLAY

A **multisyllabic word** just means a word with more than one syllable. The trick is always the same: **scoop** it into chunks, read each chunk, then **blend** them back together.

COACH'S SCRIPT

Big words are just small chunks standing together. The play is always the same: spot the vowels, scoop between them, read each chunk, then blend. Model the first word out loud, then let your reader run the play on the rest.

THE PLAY: SCOOP & BLEND

Watch how one big word breaks into chunks:

fan · tas · tic → **fantastic**

3 vowels = 3 chunks. Read each chunk, then blend them fast.

YOUR TURN: SCOOP THESE WORDS

Scoop each word into chunks, then read it smoothly.

1. **basketball** → _____

2. **wonderful** → _____

3. **dinosaur** → _____

4. **computer** → _____

5. **adventure** → _____

6. **important** → _____

✂ BONUS REP — Find the Mistake

These big words were scooped wrong. Fix the scoops.

1. **fa-ntas-tic** → _____

2. **com-put-er** → _____



Odd One Out: Syllable Sort

COACH'S SCRIPT

Time to be a word detective! In each row, three words have the same number of syllables and one is the odd one out. Say each word, clap the syllables, then circle the word that doesn't match. Finally, scoop it.

FIND THE ODD ONE OUT

In each row, **circle the word** with a different number of syllables than the other three.

1. rabbit tornado pencil basket
2. umbrella banana hospital garden
3. energy elephant computer dog
4. tomato pumpkin potato volcano
5. gigantic fantastic wonderful sit

NOW SCOOP IT

Write the odd word you circled in row 5 and scoop it into syllables:

MY GAME RECAP

Where have you seen this skill outside of reading practice?



Syllable Scooping: 4-Syllable Words

COACH'S SCRIPT

Four chunks now. These look intimidating, but the play never changes — scoop, read, blend. Praise the attempt before the accuracy: getting through a four-syllable word is real work.

SCOOP INTO 4 SYLLABLES

Make three scoops to break each word into four chunks. (Example: in · for · ma · tion)

1. **information** → _____

2. **especially** → _____

3. **invisible** → _____

4. **watermelon** → _____

5. **celebration** → _____

6. **helicopter** → _____

ALL-STAR CHALLENGE

Read this five-syllable word by scooping it: **responsibility**

✂ BONUS REP — Odd One Out

Circle the word that does NOT have four syllables.

1. **information** **especially** **helicopter** **basketball**

MY GAME RECAP

What part are you most proud of today?



Nonsense Word Decoding Practice

KNOW THE PLAY

A **nonsense word** is a made-up word that follows real spelling rules, like **blammit**. Since you can't know it from memory, you have to truly decode it — that proves your skills are real!

COACH'S SCRIPT

Nonsense words prove your reader is truly decoding, not guessing from memory. Since these words have no meaning, the only way through is to sound out each chunk. That is exactly the skill we want.

DECODE THE NONSENSE WORDS

Scoop each made-up word into syllables and read it aloud. There are no wrong meanings — just blend the sounds!

1. **blammit** → _____
2. **tropnile** → _____
3. **squbberton** → _____
4. **plindap** → _____
5. **grentish** → _____
6. **fandoodle** → _____

COACH TIP

If a nonsense word is read smoothly, your All-Star owns the syllable types. If they stall, point to one chunk at a time — don't supply the whole word.

≤ BONUS REP — Real or Nonsense?

Write **R** for a real word or **N** for nonsense.

1. **splendid** ____ **blortish** ____ **kitchen** ____
2. **frindop** ____ **magnet** ____ **splonk** ____

**COACH'S SCRIPT**

This page mixes 2-, 3-, and 4-syllable words so your reader can't predict the pattern. That's on purpose. Real reading is mixed. Scoop, read, blend — one word at a time.

MIXED WORD WORKOUT

Scoop each word, then read it. Write how many syllables it has.

1. **rocket** → _____ # syll: _____
2. **butterfly** → _____ # syll: _____
3. **calculator** → _____ # syll: _____
4. **magnet** → _____ # syll: _____
5. **community** → _____ # syll: _____
6. **champion** → _____ # syll: _____

READ IT IN A SENTENCE

Pick one word above and use it in a sentence:

MY GAME RECAP

In your own words, what did you practice on this page?



Section 1 Review & Assessment

COACH'S SCRIPT

The final check for Section 1. Let your All-Star work independently, then review together using the Answer Key in the back of the book (page 99). Celebrate how far they've come — from single sounds to big, multisyllabic words.

SKILL ASSESSMENT

Show what you know:

1. Name the CLOVER syllable type in **boat**: _____
2. Scoop **fantastic** into syllables: _____
3. Which word has an R-controlled vowel? (a) cake (b) bird (c) seat
4. How many syllables are in **information**? _____

SELF-REFLECTION

Which skill in this section made you feel most like an All-Star? _____

Answers are in the Answer Key on page 99.

WORD SEARCH CHALLENGE

Find and circle these words (across, down, and diagonal):

Syllable • Closed • Silent • Vowel • Blend • Chunk • Open

C	H	U	N	K	R	C	S	W	I	K	Y
H	Q	J	A	C	S	Y	I	D	M	D	J
M	V	C	A	D	V	A	L	G	G	B	P
M	W	O	N	M	N	C	E	S	U	G	Y
V	I	E	W	K	C	J	N	K	N	E	D
A	L	N	Y	E	D	E	T	E	L	E	H
B	W	D	A	B	L	O	P	B	S	Z	P
F	V	R	G	O	Q	O	A	O	G	X	Y
E	N	U	M	D	M	L	L	N	G	A	I
Z	S	J	A	G	L	C	F	M	T	U	S
D	B	E	G	Y	O	I	A	Y	T	K	J
M	C	C	S	C	G	S	U	H	A	T	L

MY GAME RECAP

What was the trickiest part, and how did you work through it?



WORD POWER

MORPHOLOGY • PAGES 29–48

YOUR LINEUP FOR THIS SECTION

- | | | |
|---|--------------------------------|-------------|
| 1 | Word Trees & Morphology Basics | Pages 29–30 |
| 2 | Power Prefixes | Pages 31–36 |
| 3 | Super Suffixes | Pages 37–42 |
| 4 | Greek & Latin Roots | Pages 43–46 |
| 5 | Putting Words Together | Pages 47–48 |

COACH'S HUDDLE

Now your All-Star becomes a **word detective**. Most big words are really small word-parts snapped together like LEGO bricks: a *prefix* at the front, a *root* in the middle, a *suffix* at the end. Once your reader can spot these parts, they can unlock thousands of words they have never seen before — no dictionary required.

WARM-UP CHALLENGE

Try this with your Coach: the word **unhelpful** has three parts. Pull them apart and say what each one does:

- un-** means _____
- help** means _____
- ful** means _____



The Word Tree

KNOW THE PLAY

Big words are built from **word parts**: a **prefix** at the front, a **root** in the middle, and a **suffix** at the end. **re+play+ing** = replaying.

COACH'S SCRIPT

Every big word is like a tree. The **root** holds the main meaning. **Prefixes** grow off the front and **suffixes** grow off the back. Add parts, and the word grows new branches — and new meanings!

THE THREE WORD PARTS

1. **Prefix** — added to the *front*. **re-** in **replay** means "again."
2. **Root** — the core meaning. Example: **play**.
3. **Suffix** — added to the *end*. **-er** in **player** means "one who."

BUILD THE WORD TREE

Split each word into its parts.

Word	Prefix	Root	Suffix
a. rebuilding	_____	_____	_____
b. unkindly	_____	_____	_____
c. helpful	_____	_____	_____

COACH'S TIP

If a word part can stand alone as its own word, it is the **root**. Cover the prefix and suffix with your finger and read just the root first!

MY GAME RECAP

Explain today's skill to your Coach as if they were a teammate:

**Power Prefixes: un– & re–****KNOW THE PLAY**

A **prefix** is a word part added to the **front** of a word that changes its meaning. **un–** means "not" (unhappy) and **re–** means "again" (redo).

COACH'S SCRIPT

A prefix changes a word's meaning before you even reach the root. Teach these two first — the most common prefixes in English. Have your All-Star read the new word, then say what changed.

MEET THE PREFIXES

un– means "not" / "the opposite of." *happy → unhappy*

re– means "again" / "back." *read → reread*

ADD THE PREFIX

Add **un–** or **re–**, then say the new meaning aloud.

1. un + lock = _____ means _____
2. re + write = _____ means _____
3. un + fair = _____ means _____
4. re + fill = _____ means _____

YOUR TURN

Write one sentence using an **un–** word and one using a **re–** word.



SECTION 2 • WORD POWER

Power Prefixes: **dis-** & **pre-**

KNOW THE PLAY

Two more prefixes: **dis-** means "not" or "opposite" (disagree), and **pre-** means "before" (preview).

COACH'S SCRIPT

Two more high-value prefixes. **dis-** flips a word to its opposite; **pre-** means it happens first. Watch for them in *disappear* and *preview*.

MEET THE PREFIXES

dis- means "not" / "opposite of." *agree* → *disagree*

pre- means "before." *view* → *preview*

MATCH THE MEANING

Write the letter to match each word to its meaning.

- | | |
|---------------|---------------------------|
| ___ disobey | A. to heat before |
| ___ preheat | B. to <i>not</i> obey |
| ___ dishonest | C. a test before learning |
| ___ pretest | D. <i>not</i> honest |

YOUR TURN

Pick **dis-** or **pre-** and build a new word. Use it in a sentence.

MY GAME RECAP

Give one example of how you could use this skill in a real book:

**Power Prefixes: mis–****KNOW THE PLAY**

The prefix **mis–** means "wrong" or "badly." When you add it, something went wrong: **misspell** means to spell it wrong.

COACH'S SCRIPT

The prefix **mis–** means "wrong" or "badly" — *mistake, misread, misbehave*. When your All-Star spots it, they instantly know something went wrong in the word.

MEET THE PREFIX

mis– means "wrong" or "badly."

mis + spell = misspell (to spell wrong)

mis + understand = misunderstand (to understand wrong)

BUILD & DEFINE

Add **mis–**, write the word, then explain what went wrong.

1. mis + count = _____ means _____
2. mis + place = _____ means _____
3. mis + lead = _____ means _____

CHALLENGE

What is the difference between *read*, *reread*, and *misread*? Explain to your Coach.



Prefix Word-Building

COACH'S SCRIPT

Time to combine everything. Mix any prefix with any root. Read each combination aloud — some make real words, some don't. That is part of the game!

THE PREFIX MATRIX

Combine a prefix from the top with a root on the side. Write three real words you can make.

	un—	re—	dis—	pre—
view	.	review	.	preview
happy	unhappy	.	.	.
connect	.	reconnect	disconnect	.

MY THREE WORDS

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

MY GAME RECAP

What is one thing you understand now that you did not before?



Prefix Sentence Practice

COACH'S SCRIPT

Now we use prefix words in real sentences. Read each one with your All-Star and choose the Word Bank word that fits. Context is the clue.

WORD BANK: unlock • rebuild • disappear • preview • misplace

COMPLETE THE SENTENCE

1. Please _____ the door with your key so we can go inside.
2. After the storm, the team had to _____ their treehouse.
3. We watched a _____ of the movie before it came out.
4. If you _____ your homework, you will not be able to turn it in.
5. Watch the magician make the coin _____ before your eyes!

YOUR TURN

Write your own sentence using any prefix word from this section.

MY GAME RECAP

Write one question you still have about this skill:



Power Prefixes Review

COACH'S SCRIPT

This page checks what your All-Star has mastered. Let them work independently, then review together. Celebrate every prefix they spot — it is a real reading superpower.

PART 1: MATCH THE PREFIX TO ITS MEANING

- | | | | |
|----------|-------------------|----------|-------------------|
| ___ un- | A. before | ___ dis- | C. wrong / badly |
| ___ re- | B. again / back | ___ pre- | D. not / opposite |
| ___ mis- | E. not / opposite | | |

PART 2: UNDERLINE THE PREFIX, WRITE THE ROOT

1. unfriendly → root: _____
2. preschool → root: _____
3. disappear → root: _____
4. rewrite → root: _____

ALL-STAR CHECK

I can find a prefix and use it to figure out a word's meaning. YES / GETTING THERE

MY GAME RECAP

Rate this page 1-5 stars and tell why:



Super Suffixes: -ful & -less

KNOW THE PLAY

A **suffix** is a word part added to the **end** of a word. **-ful** means "full of" (hopeful) and **-less** means "without" (hopeless).

COACH'S SCRIPT

Suffixes attach to the *end* of a word and often change its meaning. **-ful** means "full of" and **-less** means "without" — perfect opposites to learn together.

MEET THE SUFFIXES

-ful means "full of." *hope* → *hopeful*

-less means "without." *hope* → *hopeless*

FULL OF IT OR WITHOUT IT?

Add the suffix that matches the meaning.

1. A day with lots of joy is a _____ day. (joy + ____)
2. A puppy with no fear is _____. (fear + ____)
3. A backpack full of color is _____. (color + ____)
4. A room with no use is _____. (use + ____)

YOUR TURN

Choose a root and make BOTH a -ful and a -less word. Explain the difference.

MY GAME RECAP

What is one word or example from this page you want to remember?



Super Suffixes: -ly & -tion

KNOW THE PLAY

More suffixes: **-ly** tells *how* something is done (slowly), and **-tion** turns an action into a thing (celebrate → celebration).

COACH'S SCRIPT

-ly turns a word into *how* something is done (quick → quickly). **-tion** turns an action into a *thing* (act → action). Both show up constantly in school reading.

MEET THE SUFFIXES

-ly means "in a ___ way." *slow* → *slowly*

-tion turns an action into a thing. *celebrate* → *celebration*

ADD THE SUFFIX

1. quiet + ly = _____
2. brave + ly = _____
3. invent + ion = _____
4. subtract + ion = _____

CHALLENGE

Change *act* into an -ly word AND a -tion word. Use each in a sentence.



Super Suffixes: -ment

KNOW THE PLAY

The suffix **-ment** turns an action into a thing you can name: **move** → **movement**, **enjoy** → **enjoyment**.

COACH'S SCRIPT

The suffix **-ment** turns a verb (an action) into a noun (a thing). *Move* becomes *movement*; *excite* becomes *excitement*.
Quiet but powerful.

MEET THE SUFFIX

-ment turns an action into a thing you can name.

enjoy → *enjoyment* *pay* → *payment* *agree* → *agreement*

BUILD THE NOUN

1. amaze + ment = _____
2. treat + ment = _____
3. improve + ment = _____
4. state + ment = _____

YOUR TURN

Write a sentence about sports using an -ment word.



Suffix Transformations

COACH'S SCRIPT

Suffixes can change a word's *job*. This page shows how an action word (verb) becomes a naming word (noun). Say both forms aloud to hear the change.

VERB → NOUN

Verb (action)

teach

govern

act

+ Suffix

-er

-ment

-ion

Noun (thing)

teacher

government

action

YOUR TRANSFORMATIONS

Add a suffix (-er, -ment, or -ion) to turn each action into a thing.

1. paint → _____

2. protect → _____

3. enjoy → _____

ALL-STAR CHECK

I can turn an action word into a naming word using a suffix.

MY GAME RECAP

How would you teach this skill to a younger player?



Suffix Practice

COACH'S SCRIPT

More practice combining roots with suffixes. Sometimes the root changes a little (happy → happiness). Read each finished word aloud to check it.

SUFFIX BANK: -ful • -less • -ly • -ment • -tion

PICK THE RIGHT SUFFIX

1. The coach gave clear direc_____ so we knew what to do.
2. She smiled cheer_____ as she crossed the finish line.
3. A glass with no water is water_____.
4. The team made a big improve_____ this season.
5. He spoke so kind_____ that everyone felt welcome.

YOUR TURN

Write two words of your own — one with a prefix and one with a suffix.

MY GAME RECAP

What is your next goal for this skill?



Super Suffixes Review

COACH'S SCRIPT

A check-in on suffix skills. Let your All-Star try first, then talk it through. Notice how much they can read now just by recognizing word parts!

PART 1: WHAT DOES EACH SUFFIX MEAN?

- ful _____
- less _____
- ly _____
- ment _____

PART 2: BUILD & READ

1. thank + ful = _____
2. help + less = _____
3. safe + ly = _____
4. excite + ment = _____

ALL-STAR CHECK

I can use suffixes to read and understand longer words. YES / GETTING THERE

WORD SEARCH CHALLENGE

Find and circle these words (across, down, and diagonal):

Fearless • Hopeful • Payment • Slowly • Action • Kindly

Q	L	I	L	O	I	T	I	M	E	S	P
R	K	H	S	H	G	W	L	E	C	N	U
U	F	I	O	M	A	X	N	B	H	E	P
Z	W	E	N	O	U	I	F	X	N	X	I
Y	Z	L	A	D	G	S	L	O	W	L	Y
W	U	H	L	R	L	Q	W	V	E	W	P
T	H	O	X	A	L	Y	P	G	T	B	A
S	W	P	S	C	B	E	L	S	X	S	Y
K	F	E	J	T	G	F	S	Z	V	R	M
D	H	F	F	I	C	N	U	S	T	R	E
Z	R	U	W	O	B	O	K	U	C	Q	N
A	E	L	J	N	D	N	J	I	S	T	T



KNOW THE PLAY

A **root** is the core of a word that carries its main meaning. Many roots come from Greek and Latin. Learn one root, like **tele** (far), and you unlock a whole family: telephone, television, telescope.

COACH'S SCRIPT

Here is the secret pros use: many big words share the same ancient root. Learn ONE root and you unlock a whole family of words. These roots are over 2,000 years old and still working today!

WHAT IS A ROOT?

A **root** is the core of a word that carries its main meaning. Roots came from Greek and Latin long ago.

The root **tele** means "far." That is why we have **tele**phone, **tele**vision, and **tele**scope — all about something *far* away!

ROOT FAMILIES

tri = three (**tri**angle, **tri**cycle, **tri**o)

aqua = water (**aqua**rium, **aqua**tic)

audi = hear (**audi**o, **audi**ence, **audi**tion)

CHALLENGE

If *tri* means three, how many wheels does a **tricycle** have? _____

MY GAME RECAP

Where have you seen this skill outside of reading practice?



SECTION 2 • WORD POWER

Root: spect (to see)

KNOW THE PLAY

The root **spect** means "to see" or "look." It hides inside **inspect**, **spectator**, and **respect**.

COACH'S SCRIPT

The root **spect** means "to see or look." Once your All-Star knows it, *inspect*, *spectator*, and *respect* start to make sense. Look for the "seeing" idea in each word.

THE ROOT: SPECT = SEE / LOOK

inspect to look closely *into* something

spectator a person who *watches* a game

inspector a person whose job is to look closely

USE THE ROOT

Use a *spect* word above to finish each sentence.

1. The crowd of _____ cheered when the All-Star scored.
2. The coach will _____ the field before the game.
3. An _____ checks that the gym is clean and safe.

YOUR TURN

Why does *spectator* contain "spect"? Explain how the meaning connects to seeing.

MY GAME RECAP

What part are you most proud of today?



SECTION 2 • WORD POWER

Root: struct (to build)

KNOW THE PLAY

The root **struct** means "to build." Find it in **construct**, **structure**, and **instruct** (to build knowledge in someone).

COACH'S SCRIPT

struct means "to build." It hides inside *construct*, *structure*, and *instruct* (to build knowledge in someone). Picture building something whenever you see this root.

THE ROOT: STRUCT = BUILD

construct to *build* something

structure something that has been built

destruct to un-build / tear down

instruct to "build" knowledge — to teach

MATCH THE WORD

- | | |
|----------------|-------------------------------------|
| ___ construct | A. a teacher who builds your skills |
| ___ structure | B. to build |
| ___ instructor | C. a thing that has been built |

CHALLENGE

An *instructor* builds something you cannot see. What does an instructor build?

MY GAME RECAP

In your own words, what did you practice on this page?



SECTION 2 • WORD POWER

Roots: port & dict

KNOW THE PLAY

Two more roots: **port** means "to carry" (portable, transport) and **dict** means "to say" (predict, dictionary).

COACH'S SCRIPT

Two roots in one page. **port** means "to carry"; **dict** means "to say." A *portable* speaker can be *carried*; when you *predict*, you *say* what will happen before it does.

PORT = CARRY

portable (able to be carried) • *transport* (carry across) • *import* (carry in)

DICT = SAY

predict (say before) • *dictate* (say aloud to write) • *dictionary* (says what words mean)

WHICH ROOT?

Write **port** or **dict**, then say what it means.

1. predict → root: _____ means _____
2. transport → root: _____ means _____
3. dictionary → root: _____ means _____

MY GAME RECAP

What was the trickiest part, and how did you work through it?



Word Webs & Roots

COACH'S SCRIPT

A word web shows how one root grows a whole family. Pick a root your All-Star knows and brainstorm every word you can think of together. The bigger the web, the stronger their vocabulary.

BUILD A WORD WEB

Write words that contain the root **spect** (= to see) and what each means.

Root: **SPECT** = to see / look

Word 1: _____ means _____

Word 2: _____ means _____

Word 3: _____ means _____

MATCHING GAME

___ tri

A. water

___ port

C. carry

___ aqua

B. three

___ dict

D. say

MY GAME RECAP

Explain today's skill to your Coach as if they were a teammate:



SECTION 2 • WORD POWER

Section 2 Review

COACH'S SCRIPT

The Word Power section is complete! This review pulls together prefixes, suffixes, and roots. Let your All-Star show off everything they have learned — they can now break apart words that used to look impossible.

PART 1: NAME THE WORD PART

Is each one a prefix (P), suffix (S), or root (R)?

___ re-

___ -ful

___ spect

___ -ment

___ dis-

___ struct

___ -ly

___ pre-

PART 2: BREAK IT APART

Split each word into its parts.

1. unhelpful = _____ + _____ + _____

2. reconstruction = _____ + _____ + _____

SECTION 2 COMPLETE!

I can break a big word into a prefix, root, and suffix to find its meaning. Signed:

WORD SEARCH CHALLENGE

Find and circle these words (across, down, and diagonal):

Rebuild • Prefix • Suffix • Struct • Spect • Root

O	S	Z	L	O	S	K	W	R	U	O	M
Y	Z	C	P	A	G	E	R	E	F	T	Z
W	P	R	E	F	I	X	X	B	A	J	Q
P	E	D	D	S	M	B	C	U	O	X	R
J	M	Q	H	F	P	R	Q	I	L	C	H
J	J	F	U	K	M	E	P	L	K	O	Z
C	Y	Z	I	P	S	E	C	D	D	V	S
P	M	M	A	T	T	I	X	T	C	J	U
C	B	O	O	B	R	I	F	P	S	P	F
P	B	O	Q	B	U	P	C	S	O	H	F
Y	R	Y	S	O	C	W	X	I	V	C	I
T	A	B	K	Y	T	U	M	N	L	B	X



SMOOTH SAILING

FLUENCY & PROSODY • PAGES 49–68

YOUR LINEUP FOR THIS SECTION

- | | | |
|---|------------------------|-------------|
| 1 | Robot vs. Storyteller | Pages 49–50 |
| 2 | Phrase-Cued Reading | Pages 51–56 |
| 3 | Repeated Reading & WPM | Pages 57–62 |
| 4 | Readers' Theater | Pages 63–67 |
| 5 | Section 3 Review | Page 68 |

COACH'S HUDDLE

Your All-Star can decode the words — now we make their reading **smooth**. Fluent readers read in phrases, not word-by-word, and they use their voice to show meaning. That is called *prosody*. The big idea this section: read like a **storyteller**, not a robot. Smooth reading also frees up the brain to understand what the words mean.

WARM-UP CHALLENGE

Try this with your Coach. Read this sentence twice:

"The big dog ran fast."

First like a **robot** (flat, one word at a time). Then like a **storyteller** (smooth, with feeling). Which one sounded better?



Robot vs. Storyteller

KNOW THE PLAY

Reading like a **robot** is flat and choppy, one word at a time. Reading like a **storyteller** is smooth, with feeling. That smooth, expressive reading is called **fluency**.

COACH'S SCRIPT

Read the same line two ways so your All-Star can *hear* the difference. Robot reading is choppy and flat. Storyteller reading flows and has expression. Ham it up — make the robot funny and the storyteller dramatic!

TWO WAYS TO READ

ROBOT: "The. cat. sat. on. the. mat." (flat, choppy, no feeling)

STORYTELLER: "The cat sat on the mat." (smooth, grouped, with voice)

YOUR TURN TO PERFORM

Read each line like a storyteller. Put a ★ next to the one you read most smoothly.

1. The crowd roared as the runner crossed the line!
2. "Watch out!" she shouted from across the field.
3. Slowly, quietly, the team walked into the gym.

COACH'S CHECK

Did your reading sound more like a robot or a storyteller? Circle one and try again to beat it.

MY GAME RECAP

Give one example of how you could use this skill in a real book:

**KNOW THE PLAY**

Phrase-cued reading means grouping words into little phrases that belong together, instead of reading word-by-word.

The / marks show where to pause: *On the morning / of the big game / ...*

COACH'S SCRIPT

Fluent readers group words into *phrases*. The little slash marks (/) show where to take a tiny pause — like breath marks in music. Read up to each slash, then pause. This trains smooth, meaningful reading.

WHAT IS A PHRASE?

A phrase is a small group of words that belong together. The marks below show where to pause:

The tall player / jumped high / and scored / the winning point. //

One slash (/) = short pause. Two slashes (//) = full stop.

READ WITH THE PHRASES

Read aloud, pausing at each slash.

Every morning / the young athlete / woke up early / to practice. // She knew / that hard work / would pay off / on game day. //

ALL-STAR CHECK

I paused at each slash and my reading sounded smooth. YES / GETTING THERE

MY GAME RECAP

What is one thing you understand now that you did not before?



Phrase-Cued Practice 1

COACH'S SCRIPT

Phrase-cued practice builds the habit of reading in groups. First read the marked passage. Then have your All-Star add their own slash marks to the unmarked one — this shows they can find phrase boundaries on their own.

PART 1: READ THE MARKED PASSAGE

The soccer team / ran onto the field / as the crowd / cheered loudly. // Their best player / dribbled the ball / past two defenders / and took a shot. //

PART 2: MARK YOUR OWN

Add slash marks (/) where you would pause as you read this aloud.

The goalie dove to the right but the ball curved into the left corner of the net.

ALL-STAR CHECK

My phrasing helped the sentence make sense. YES / GETTING THERE

MY GAME RECAP

Write one question you still have about this skill:



Phrase-Cued Practice 2

COACH'S SCRIPT

Phrase-cued practice builds the habit of reading in groups. First read the marked passage. Then have your All-Star add their own slash marks to the unmarked one — this shows they can find phrase boundaries on their own.

PART 1: READ THE MARKED PASSAGE

After school / the friends / met at the park / to shoot hoops. // They played / until the sun / began to set / behind the trees. //

PART 2: MARK YOUR OWN

Add slash marks (/) where you would pause as you read this aloud.

One player practiced free throws while the others worked on passing the ball back and forth.

ALL-STAR CHECK

My phrasing helped the sentence make sense. YES / GETTING THERE

MY GAME RECAP

Rate this page 1-5 stars and tell why:



Phrase-Cued Practice 3

COACH'S SCRIPT

Phrase-cued practice builds the habit of reading in groups. First read the marked passage. Then have your All-Star add their own slash marks to the unmarked one — this shows they can find phrase boundaries on their own.

PART 1: READ THE MARKED PASSAGE

The marathon / was long and hard / but the runner / never gave up. // Step by step / she moved forward / thinking only / about the finish line. //

PART 2: MARK YOUR OWN

Add slash marks (/) where you would pause as you read this aloud.

Near the end of the race her legs felt heavy but the cheering crowd gave her new energy.

ALL-STAR CHECK

My phrasing helped the sentence make sense. YES / GETTING THERE

MY GAME RECAP

What is one word or example from this page you want to remember?



Phrase-Cued Practice 4

COACH'S SCRIPT

Phrase-cued practice builds the habit of reading in groups. First read the marked passage. Then have your All-Star add their own slash marks to the unmarked one — this shows they can find phrase boundaries on their own.

PART 1: READ THE MARKED PASSAGE

On the morning / of the big game / the gym was packed / with excited fans. // Both teams / warmed up carefully / stretching their muscles / and taking practice shots. //

PART 2: COACH THE COACH

Uh oh — a rookie coach put the slash marks in the **wrong** places! Read it aloud the way the slashes show. Does it sound choppy? Cross out the bad slashes and draw new ones where they belong.

When the / whistle blew the players / sprinted down / the court ready to give / their very best.

Now write it with **your** slash marks:

ALL-STAR CHECK

My phrasing helped the sentence make sense. YES / GETTING THERE

MY GAME RECAP

How would you teach this skill to a younger player?



Phrase-Cued Review

COACH'S SCRIPT

This review checks phrasing skills. Let your All-Star mark the passage independently, then read it aloud. Good phrasing is one of the clearest signs that reading is becoming automatic.

MARK AND READ

Add slash marks where you would pause, then read it aloud like a storyteller.

The young pitcher took a deep breath stepped onto the mound and looked toward home plate. The batter waited ready to swing as the ball flew through the air toward the catcher's glove.

PHRASING CHECKLIST

- ☐ I read in groups of words, not one at a time.
- ☐ I paused at the right places.
- ☐ My reading sounded smooth and natural.

MY GAME RECAP

What is your next goal for this skill?



Repeated Reading: The Brain Game

KNOW THE PLAY

Repeated reading means reading the same passage a few times to get faster and smoother. **WPM** stands for **Words Per Minute** — it measures your reading speed.

COACH'S SCRIPT

This is a **repeated reading**. Your All-Star reads the same passage three times and charts their speed. Speed should climb each read — that is fluency growing in real time. Time exactly one minute per read and count errors together.

THE BRAIN GAME

Have you ever wondered how athletes get so good? The secret is inside their brains. Every time you practice a skill, tiny wires in your brain called neurons fire together. When they fire over and over, your brain wraps them in a special coating called myelin. Myelin is like tape around a wire. It makes the signal travel faster and smoother. The more you practice, the more myelin you build. That is why a free throw that felt hard last month can feel easy today. Your brain literally rebuilt itself! Reading works the same way. Every time you read, you wrap a little more myelin around your reading wires. So keep practicing, All-Star. You are not just reading — you are building a faster, stronger brain.

CHART YOUR SPEED

Read	Time	Words Read	Errors	WPM
Cold Read	_____	_____	_____	_____
2nd Read	_____	_____	_____	_____
Hot Read	_____	_____	_____	_____

Errors = words skipped, read wrong, or stuck on. WPM = (Words Read – Errors) ÷ minutes.

MY GAME RECAP

Where have you seen this skill outside of reading practice?



Repeated Reading 2

COACH'S SCRIPT

Repeated reading #2. Same routine: read three times, chart the speed each time, and celebrate the jump from Cold Read to Hot Read. Remind your All-Star that smoother reading means their brain is building myelin — just like the passage on page 57!

THE BIG GAME

The score was tied and only one minute remained. Maria dribbled the ball down the court, her heart pounding. She could hear her teammates calling for the ball. With seconds left, she spotted an open path to the basket. She drove forward, jumped, and released the ball at just the right moment. The whole gym went silent as the ball arced through the air. Then it dropped through the net! The buzzer sounded and her team had won. Maria smiled, knowing that all those hours of practice had paid off when it mattered most.

CHART YOUR SPEED

Read	Time	Words Read	Errors	WPM
Cold Read	_____	_____	_____	_____
2nd Read	_____	_____	_____	_____
Hot Read	_____	_____	_____	_____

Errors = words skipped, read wrong, or stuck on. WPM = (Words Read – Errors) ÷ minutes.

MY GAME RECAP

What part are you most proud of today?



Repeated Reading 3

COACH'S SCRIPT

Repeated reading #3. Same routine: read three times, chart the speed each time, and celebrate the jump from Cold Read to Hot Read. Remind your All-Star that smoother reading means their brain is building myelin — just like the passage on page 57!

THE EARLY RISER

Before the sun came up, Devon was already awake. He pulled on his running shoes and stepped outside into the cool morning air. The streets were quiet and empty. Devon had a goal: he wanted to run a full mile without stopping. He started slowly, breathing in and out, finding his rhythm. At first his legs felt heavy, but soon he settled into a steady pace. Block by block, he kept going. When he finally reached the corner that marked one mile, he raised his arms in victory. He had done it, and tomorrow he would try for even more.

CHART YOUR SPEED

Read	Time	Words Read	Errors	WPM
Cold Read	_____	_____	_____	_____
2nd Read	_____	_____	_____	_____
Hot Read	_____	_____	_____	_____

Errors = words skipped, read wrong, or stuck on. WPM = (Words Read – Errors) ÷ minutes.

MY GAME RECAP

In your own words, what did you practice on this page?



Repeated Reading 4

COACH'S SCRIPT

Repeated reading #4. Same routine: read three times, chart the speed each time, and celebrate the jump from Cold Read to Hot Read. Remind your All-Star that smoother reading means their brain is building myelin — just like the passage on page 57!

THE COMEBACK KID

Sofia had never been the fastest player on the tennis team. In her first match, she lost every game. Some kids might have quit, but not Sofia. She asked her coach for extra help and practiced every single day. She learned to watch the ball closely and to move her feet quickly. Slowly, her game improved. By the end of the season, Sofia surprised everyone. In the final match, she stayed calm and focused, point after point. When she hit the winning shot, the crowd cheered. Sofia had proven that practice and heart can beat raw talent.

CHART YOUR SPEED

Read	Time	Words Read	Errors	WPM
Cold Read	_____	_____	_____	_____
2nd Read	_____	_____	_____	_____
Hot Read	_____	_____	_____	_____

Errors = words skipped, read wrong, or stuck on. WPM = (Words Read – Errors) ÷ minutes.

MY GAME RECAP

What was the trickiest part, and how did you work through it?



Repeated Reading 5

COACH'S SCRIPT

Repeated reading #5. Same routine: read three times, chart the speed each time, and celebrate the jump from Cold Read to Hot Read. Remind your All-Star that smoother reading means their brain is building myelin — just like the passage on page 57!

THE TEAM CAPTAIN

Being captain was not about being the best player. Jordan learned this lesson early in the season. As captain, his job was to lift up his teammates, especially when things went wrong. When a younger player missed an easy goal, Jordan did not get angry. Instead, he ran over and said, "Shake it off. You will get the next one." That player scored twice in the second half. After the game, the coach told Jordan that good leaders make everyone around them better. Jordan realized that helping his team was even more rewarding than scoring himself.

CHART YOUR SPEED

Read	Time	Words Read	Errors	WPM
Cold Read	_____	_____	_____	_____
2nd Read	_____	_____	_____	_____
Hot Read	_____	_____	_____	_____

Errors = words skipped, read wrong, or stuck on. WPM = (Words Read – Errors) ÷ minutes.

MY GAME RECAP

Explain today's skill to your Coach as if they were a teammate:



Repeated Reading 6

COACH'S SCRIPT

Repeated reading #6. Same routine: read three times, chart the speed each time, and celebrate the jump from Cold Read to Hot Read. Remind your All-Star that smoother reading means their brain is building myelin — just like the passage on page 57!

THE PERFECT PRACTICE

Coach Lee always said, "Practice does not make perfect. Perfect practice makes perfect." At first, the players did not understand. Then Coach Lee explained. If you practice a skill the wrong way, you only get better at doing it wrong. But if you slow down and practice carefully, your brain learns the right pattern. The team began to focus on doing each drill correctly, even if it meant going slower. Within weeks, their games improved dramatically. They discovered that careful, focused practice was the real secret to becoming great at anything.

CHART YOUR SPEED

Read	Time	Words Read	Errors	WPM
Cold Read	_____	_____	_____	_____
2nd Read	_____	_____	_____	_____
Hot Read	_____	_____	_____	_____

Errors = words skipped, read wrong, or stuck on. WPM = (Words Read – Errors) ÷ minutes.

MY GAME RECAP

Give one example of how you could use this skill in a real book:



Readers' Theater: The Comeback

KNOW THE PLAY

Readers' Theater is like acting out a script. Each person reads a character's lines out loud with expression. It's a fun way to practice reading with feeling.

COACH'S SCRIPT

Readers' Theater builds fluency through performance. You and your All-Star each take a part and read with expression. You are COACH; your All-Star is ALL-STAR. Read it through once, then perform it with feeling. There are no costumes needed — just your best storyteller voices!

THE COMEBACK — A PLAY IN TWO VOICES

CHARACTERS: COACH and ALL-STAR. Setting: the bench, late in a tough game.

ALL-STAR Coach, we're losing by ten points. Maybe we just can't win this one.

COACH Listen, All-Star. Do you remember what we learned about the brain?

ALL-STAR You mean... the myelin? The stuff that makes our skills faster?

COACH Exactly. Every practice, every drill, you've been building it. That work is still in there.

ALL-STAR So you think we can still come back?

COACH I think you've trained for this exact moment. Now go show them what you built.

ALL-STAR But Coach, their best player is so much taller than me.

COACH Taller, yes. But have they practiced like you have? Size is not the whole game.

ALL-STAR I guess not. We did run those drills every single morning.

COACH Rain or shine. That kind of work does not disappear when the score gets close.

ALL-STAR You're right. My legs remember. My hands remember.

COACH Now your brain has to remember too. Trust the training, not the scoreboard.

**COACH'S SCRIPT**

Part two of The Comeback. Keep your voices expressive! Notice how the punctuation guides your tone — exclamation points mean energy, question marks lift your voice at the end.

THE COMEBACK — SCENE 2

Setting: back on the court, the score is closing.

ALL-STAR Coach! Did you see that? I made three shots in a row!

COACH I saw it. Your practice is paying off right when it counts.

ALL-STAR We're only down by two now. There's one minute left!

COACH Stay calm. Breathe. Read the game the way you read a story — one play at a time.

ALL-STAR One play at a time. I can do that.

COACH That's my All-Star. Now go finish what you started.

ALL-STAR Coach, ten seconds left! They're passing it to me!

COACH Breathe. You have done this a thousand times in practice.

ALL-STAR Three... two... I'm shooting!

COACH (quietly) ...Nothing but net.

ALL-STAR WE WON! Coach, we actually won!

COACH No, All-Star. YOU won. You read the moment and trusted your skills. That's a champion.



Readers' Theater 2: Game Day Jitters

COACH'S SCRIPT

A new script. This one is about nerves before a big game. Help your All-Star read the worried lines softly and the confident lines strongly — matching voice to feeling is what prosody is all about.

GAME DAY JITTERS — SCENE 1

CHARACTERS: COACH and ALL-STAR. Setting: the locker room before a championship.

ALL-STAR Coach, my hands are shaking. What if I mess up in front of everyone?

COACH Feeling nervous means you care. Even the pros feel it.

ALL-STAR Really? Even the professionals get scared?

COACH Every one of them. The trick is to turn those nerves into energy.

ALL-STAR How do I do that?

COACH Take a deep breath. Picture yourself succeeding. Then trust your practice.

ALL-STAR Coach, my stomach feels like it's full of butterflies.

COACH Every great player feels those butterflies. The trick is making them fly in formation.

ALL-STAR Fly in formation? What does that even mean?

COACH It means using the nervous energy to focus instead of freeze. Channel it into your first move.

ALL-STAR So being nervous isn't bad?

COACH Not at all. It means you care. Now take a deep breath and let's warm up together.

**COACH'S SCRIPT**

Scene two of Game Day Jitters. By now your All-Star should be reading these lines smoothly. Try switching parts so they get to read both COACH and ALL-STAR!

GAME DAY JITTERS — SCENE 2

Setting: stepping onto the court.

ALL-STAR Okay. Deep breath. I can picture the shot going in.

COACH There you go. How do your hands feel now?

ALL-STAR Steadier. The nerves turned into something... like excitement!

COACH That's the feeling champions chase. Now go play your game.

ALL-STAR Thanks, Coach. I'm ready.

COACH I never doubted you for a second.

ALL-STAR Okay. The whistle's about to blow. I'm ready... I think.

COACH You ARE ready. Remember the plan: watch the ball, trust your feet.

ALL-STAR Watch the ball, trust my feet. Watch the ball, trust my feet.

COACH There it is. And look — the butterflies are flying in formation now, aren't they?

ALL-STAR They are! I feel focused instead of scared.

COACH That's reading the moment like a storyteller reads a page. Go play your game.

**COACH'S SCRIPT**

The final scene. This is a celebration — read it with joy and pride! Afterward, talk about how the characters changed from the beginning of the play to the end.

GAME DAY JITTERS — FINAL SCENE

Setting: after the final whistle.

ALL-STAR We won, Coach! And I wasn't even scared at the end!

COACH You turned your nerves into focus. That's a skill you'll keep forever.

ALL-STAR I think I learned something bigger than basketball today.

COACH Tell me.

ALL-STAR Being brave doesn't mean you're not scared. It means you try anyway.

COACH Now THAT is an All-Star. Well played.

ALL-STAR Coach, that was the best game I've ever played!

COACH And you were nervous at the start. What changed?

ALL-STAR I stopped fighting the jitters and used them. Just like you said.

COACH Exactly. You'll feel nervous again someday — at a test, a recital, a big game.

ALL-STAR And when I do, I'll make my butterflies fly in formation.

COACH That's my All-Star. Take a bow — you earned it.



Section 3 Review

COACH'S SCRIPT

The Smooth Sailing section is complete! Your All-Star can now read in phrases, use expression, and track their own fluency growth. Review their WPM charts together and celebrate how far their speed has climbed.

PART 1: FLUENCY SELF-CHECK

- ☐ I read in phrases, not word-by-word.
- ☐ I use my voice to show meaning (storyteller, not robot).
- ☐ My Hot Read was faster than my Cold Read.

PART 2: MY FLUENCY GROWTH

Look back at your repeated reading charts. What was your highest WPM? _____

What helped your reading get smoother? _____

SECTION 3 COMPLETE!

I can read smoothly, in phrases, like a storyteller. Signed: _____

MY GAME RECAP

What is one thing you understand now that you did not before?



THINKING DEEPLY

COMPREHENSION • PAGES 69–88

YOUR LINEUP FOR THIS SECTION

- | | | |
|-------|---------------------------|-------------|
| 1 | Visualizing | Pages 69–72 |
| <hr/> | | |
| 2 | Main Idea & Details | Pages 73–78 |
| <hr/> | | |
| 3 | Inferencing | Pages 79–82 |
| <hr/> | | |
| 4 | Summarizing: SWBST & 5 Ws | Pages 83–87 |
| <hr/> | | |
| 5 | Section 4 Review | Page 88 |

COACH'S HUDDLE

Reading the words is only half the game. Now your All-Star learns to **understand and think about** what they read. Great readers make movies in their minds, find the main idea, read between the lines, and sum up what matters. These are the skills that turn a reader into a thinker. Every strategy here has a simple, sporty name your All-Star can remember.

WARM-UP CHALLENGE

Try this with your Coach. Close your eyes while your Coach reads:

"The crowd roared as the player sprinted down the field, ball at her feet, the goal just ahead."

What did you SEE in your mind? Draw or describe it: _____



Visualizing: Mental Movie 1

KNOW THE PLAY

Visualizing means making a "movie in your mind" as you read. Good readers picture the scene — what they see, hear, and feel — to understand and remember the story.

COACH'S SCRIPT

Visualizing means making a "mental movie" while you read. Good readers picture the scene, the characters, even the sounds and smells. Read each line and ask your All-Star: what do you see, hear, and feel?

MAKE A MENTAL MOVIE

Read each sentence and sketch or describe what you picture.

1. The old wooden roller coaster clacked slowly up the steep hill. I see: _____
2. Warm cookies cooled on the kitchen counter. I smell: _____
3. Thunder cracked and rain pounded on the tin roof. I hear: _____

YOUR TURN

Write a sentence so vivid that your Coach can picture it perfectly.

MY GAME RECAP

Write one question you still have about this skill:



Visualizing: Mental Movie 2

COACH'S SCRIPT

Now we visualize a longer passage. Read it together, then have your All-Star draw the most important scene. The picture in their mind shows how well they understood the words.

READ AND PICTURE

The lighthouse stood alone on the rocky cliff. Waves crashed below, sending white spray high into the air. At the top, a bright light spun in slow circles, cutting through the thick fog. A lone sailor far out at sea spotted the glow and smiled. He knew he was almost home.

DRAW THE SCENE

Draw the picture you see in your mind in the box below.

MY GAME RECAP

Rate this page 1-5 stars and tell why:



Visualizing Review

COACH'S SCRIPT

A check-in on visualizing. The goal is automatic mental movies. Ask your All-Star to explain how picturing the story helps them remember and understand it.

VISUALIZE AND DESCRIBE

Read, then describe your mental movie using your five senses.

At the championship game, the gym was packed. Sneakers squeaked on the shiny floor, the buzzer blared, and the crowd jumped to their feet.

See: _____

Hear: _____

Feel: _____

ALL-STAR CHECK

I make mental movies that help me understand what I read. YES / GETTING THERE

MY GAME RECAP

What is one word or example from this page you want to remember?



Main Idea & Details

KNOW THE PLAY

The **main idea** is the big point a paragraph is making (the tabletop). The **details** are the small facts that support it (the legs that hold the table up).

COACH'S SCRIPT

Here is the big strategy: **The Table and the Legs**. The *main idea* is the tabletop — what the whole paragraph is mostly about. The *details* are the legs that hold it up. A table needs legs, and a main idea needs details!

THE TABLE AND THE LEGS

The **MAIN IDEA** is the tabletop. The **DETAILS** are the legs that support it.

Example paragraph: "Dogs make great pets. They are loyal and loving. They can be trained to do tricks. They also keep you active with walks and play."

Tabletop (main idea): Dogs make great pets.

Leg 1: loyal and loving

Leg 2: can be trained

Leg 3: keep you active

ALL-STAR CHECK

The main idea is the **WHOLE** point; details are the little facts that support it.

MY GAME RECAP

How would you teach this skill to a younger player?

**Main Idea Practice 1****COACH'S SCRIPT**

Read the paragraph together. Find the tabletop (main idea) first, then list the legs (details) that hold it up. Remind your All-Star: the main idea is what ALL the sentences are about, not just one of them.

READ THE PARAGRAPH

Basketball is a great sport for staying healthy. Running up and down the court gives your heart a strong workout. Jumping for rebounds builds powerful legs. Even passing and dribbling sharpen your hand-eye coordination. Best of all, you can play it almost anywhere.

FIND THE TABLE AND LEGS

Main idea: _____

Detail 1: _____

Detail 2: _____

Detail 3: _____

MY GAME RECAP

What is your next goal for this skill?



Main Idea Practice 2

COACH'S SCRIPT

Read the paragraph together. Find the tabletop (main idea) first, then list the legs (details) that hold it up. Remind your All-Star: the main idea is what ALL the sentences are about, not just one of them.

READ THE PARAGRAPH

Sea turtles face many dangers in the ocean. Plastic trash can trap them or be swallowed by mistake. Boats and fishing nets can injure them. Rising ocean temperatures also harm the beaches where they lay their eggs. Scientists are working hard to protect these gentle creatures.

FIND THE TABLE AND LEGS

Main idea: _____

Detail 1: _____

Detail 2: _____

Detail 3: _____

MY GAME RECAP

Where have you seen this skill outside of reading practice?



Topic vs. Main Idea vs. Detail

KNOW THE PLAY

Don't mix these up! The **topic** is just a word or two (Penguins). The **main idea** is a full sentence (Penguins are built for the cold). A **detail** is one small fact that supports it.

COACH'S SCRIPT

These three are easy to mix up. The **topic** is one or two words (what it's about). The **main idea** is a full sentence (the big point). A **detail** is one small supporting fact. Practice sorting them so the difference sticks.

KNOW THE DIFFERENCE

TOPIC just a word or two — *Penguins*

MAIN IDEA a whole sentence — *Penguins are built for life in the cold.*

DETAIL one supporting fact — *Their feathers trap warm air.*

SORT IT OUT

Label each one T (topic), M (main idea), or D (detail).

1. ____ Volcanoes are powerful forces of nature.
2. ____ Volcanoes
3. ____ Hot melted rock called lava pours out of them.
4. ____ Recycling helps the planet in many ways.

MY GAME RECAP

What part are you most proud of today?



Main Idea Practice 3

COACH'S SCRIPT

This time the tabletop (main idea) is already filled in, plus one leg. Read the paragraph together, then have your All-Star supply the missing legs (details). Working backward like this makes them think hard about how details support the main idea.

READ THE PARAGRAPH

Practicing an instrument takes patience, but it is worth it. At first, your fingers feel clumsy and the notes sound wrong. With daily practice, your hands learn the patterns. Soon you can play songs you once thought were impossible. The secret is to practice a little every day.

FINISH THE TABLE

This time, some parts are already filled in. Read the paragraph, then add the **missing legs** (details) that hold up the main idea.

Main idea (tabletop): *Practicing an instrument every day is hard at first but worth it.*

Leg 1: *At first your fingers feel clumsy and notes sound wrong. (given)*

Leg 2: _____

Leg 3: _____

Then flip it: cover the tabletop above. Could you say the main idea in your own words just from the legs?

MY GAME RECAP

In your own words, what did you practice on this page?



Main Idea Review

COACH'S SCRIPT

A review of main idea skills. Let your All-Star work through it independently, then talk about how finding the main idea helps them remember what they read.

READ AND ANALYZE

Honeybees are some of the hardest workers in nature. A single bee may visit hundreds of flowers in one day. They carry pollen from plant to plant, helping fruits and vegetables grow. Without bees, many of the foods we love would disappear. That is why protecting bees is so important.

ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

1. Topic (1-2 words): _____
2. Main idea (full sentence): _____
3. One detail: _____

MY GAME RECAP

What was the trickiest part, and how did you work through it?



Inferencing

KNOW THE PLAY

An **inference** is a smart guess you make using **clues from the text + what you already know**. The author doesn't tell you directly — you read between the lines.

COACH'S SCRIPT

An **inference** is a smart guess based on clues. The formula: **Text Clues + My Brain = Inference**. The author does not tell you everything — good readers figure out the rest. Read between the lines!

THE INFERENCE FORMULA

TEXT CLUES + MY BRAIN = INFERENCE

Example: "Maya grabbed her umbrella and rain boots before leaving."

Text clues: umbrella, rain boots

My brain knows: people use those when it rains

Inference: It is probably raining (or about to).

ALL-STAR CHECK

An inference uses clues from the text PLUS what I already know.

MY GAME RECAP

Explain today's skill to your Coach as if they were a teammate:



Inferencing Practice 1

COACH'S SCRIPT

Read the clue together. Help your All-Star name the exact words that hint at the answer, then combine those clues with what they already know to make an inference.

READ THE CLUES

Jordan walked off the field with his head down. He did not say a word to anyone. In the dugout, he stared at his glove and sighed.

MAKE YOUR INFERENCE

Text clues: _____

My brain knows: _____

My inference: _____

Question: How is Jordan probably feeling, and how do you know?

MY GAME RECAP

Give one example of how you could use this skill in a real book:



Inferencing Practice 2

COACH'S SCRIPT

Read the clue together. Help your All-Star name the exact words that hint at the answer, then combine those clues with what they already know to make an inference.

READ THE CLUES

The kitchen smelled amazing. Grandma wore her favorite apron, and the table was set with the fancy plates. Balloons floated near the doorway.

MAKE YOUR INFERENCE

Text clues: _____

My brain knows: _____

My inference: _____

Question: What kind of event is probably happening? What clues tell you?

MY GAME RECAP

What is one thing you understand now that you did not before?



Inferencing Review

COACH'S SCRIPT

A review of inferencing. This is one of the hardest comprehension skills, so celebrate every smart guess your All-Star makes — especially when they can point to the exact clue that led them there.

READ AND INFER

When the new student walked into class, she gripped her backpack straps tightly and looked at the floor. She chose the empty seat in the very back corner and did not look up when others said hello.

ANSWER WITH EVIDENCE

1. How does the new student feel? _____
2. Which clues helped you decide? _____
3. What could a classmate do to help? _____

MY GAME RECAP

Write one question you still have about this skill:



Summarizing: SWBST

KNOW THE PLAY

SWBST is a way to summarize a story in one sentence: **S**omebody · **W**anted · **B**ut · **S**o · **T**hen.

COACH'S SCRIPT

For stories, we summarize with **SWBST**: Somebody, Wanted, But, So, Then. It turns a long story into one neat sentence. Walk through each part with a story your All-Star knows well.

THE SWBST FORMULA

Somebody Who is the main character?

Wanted What did they want?

But What was the problem?

So What did they do about it?

Then How did it end?

TRY IT WITH A STORY YOU KNOW

Think of a favorite movie or book and fill in each part.

S: _____

W: _____

B: _____

S: _____

T: _____

MY GAME RECAP

Rate this page 1-5 stars and tell why:

**SWBST Practice****COACH'S SCRIPT**

Read the short story, then summarize it using SWBST. The goal is one clear summary, not a retelling of every detail. If your All-Star starts listing everything, gently steer them back to the five parts.

READ THE STORY

Leo wanted to make the school soccer team. But when tryouts came, he was the slowest runner there. So Leo woke up early every day to run and practice his footwork. Then, at the next tryout, he made the team as one of the strongest players.

SUMMARIZE WITH SWBST

Somebody: _____

Wanted: _____

But: _____

So: _____

Then: _____

MY GAME RECAP

What is one word or example from this page you want to remember?



SECTION 4 • THINKING DEEPLY

Summarizing: The 5 Ws

KNOW THE PLAY

For facts and nonfiction, summarize with the **5 Ws**: **Who**, **What**, **When**, **Where**, and **Why**. Answer just the most important ones.

COACH'S SCRIPT

For nonfiction and news, we use the **5 Ws**: Who, What, When, Where, Why. These five questions capture the most important information in any factual passage.

THE 5 Ws

Who is it about?

What happened?

When did it happen?

Where did it happen?

Why did it happen?

PRACTICE THE 5 Ws

Passage: Last Saturday at the city park, hundreds of volunteers planted 500 new trees to help clean the air and give shade for years to come.

Who:

What:

When:

Where:

Why:

MY GAME RECAP

How would you teach this skill to a younger player?



5 Ws Practice

COACH'S SCRIPT

More 5 Ws practice with a new passage. Remind your All-Star that a good summary answers the most important Ws in just a sentence or two — not every tiny fact.

READ THE NEWS STORY

On Friday morning, the Lincoln Elementary robotics team traveled to the state capital to compete in the championship. After months of building and testing their robot, the team placed first because their design completed every challenge fastest.

ANSWER THE 5 Ws

Who: _____

What: _____

When: _____

Where: _____

Why: _____

MY GAME RECAP

What is your next goal for this skill?



Mixed Summarizing

COACH'S SCRIPT

Now your All-Star chooses the right tool. Fiction story? Use SWBST. Nonfiction facts? Use the 5 Ws. Knowing WHICH strategy to pick is a sign of a strong, flexible reader.

WHICH STRATEGY?

Write SWBST or 5 Ws for each. Then summarize one of them on the lines.

- a. A made-up story about a dragon who learns to fly → _____
- b. A news report about a science fair → _____
- c. A fairy tale about three brave siblings → _____

MY SUMMARY

Pick a book or movie and summarize it with the right strategy.

MY GAME RECAP

Where have you seen this skill outside of reading practice?



Section 4 Review

COACH'S SCRIPT

The Thinking Deeply section is complete! Your All-Star can now visualize, find the main idea, make inferences, and summarize. These comprehension skills work in every subject — not just reading. Celebrate this big milestone!

MATCH THE STRATEGY TO ITS JOB

- | | |
|-----------------|---|
| ___ Visualizing | A. Find the big point + supporting facts |
| ___ Main Idea | B. Make a mental movie |
| ___ Inferencing | C. Sum up a story (Somebody-Wanted-But-So-Then) |
| ___ SWBST | D. Use clues + your brain to read between the lines |

REFLECTION

Which thinking strategy helps you the most, and why?

SECTION 4 COMPLETE!

I can think deeply about what I read. Signed: _____

MY GAME RECAP

What part are you most proud of today?



APPLICATION

PUTTING IT ALL TOGETHER • PAGES 89–100

YOUR LINEUP FOR THIS SECTION

- | | | |
|---|----------------------------|-------------|
| 1 | Applied Reading Passages | Pages 89–96 |
| 2 | Glossary of Terms | Pages 97–98 |
| 3 | Answer Key | Page 99 |
| 4 | Certificate of Achievement | Page 100 |
| 5 | You're an All-Star Reader! | ★ |

COACH'S HUDDLE

This is the championship round! Now your All-Star uses **every skill** at once: decoding big words, spotting prefixes and roots, reading smoothly, and thinking deeply. Each passage asks them to hunt for multisyllabic words, read for fluency, and summarize what they understood. There is no single right way to play — just encourage your reader to use the whole playbook.

WARM-UP CHALLENGE

Get ready, All-Star. Look back at everything you have learned:

Which skill are you most proud of? _____

Which skill do you still want to practice? _____

**COACH'S SCRIPT**

This applied passage brings it all together. First, hunt for the big multisyllabic words and scoop them into syllables. Then read the passage smoothly, like a storyteller. You will summarize it on the next page.

⚽ THE UNDERDOG SEASON

The Riverside Rockets were not expected to win a single game. Their players were younger and less experienced than the other teams. But their coach believed in steady improvement. Every practice, the Rockets focused on the fundamentals: passing, positioning, and communication. Game by game, they got better. By the championship, the unbelievable happened — the underdog Rockets defeated the defending champions in an unforgettable comeback victory.

WORD HUNT

Find and write three multisyllabic (2+ syllable) words. Scoop each into syllables.

1. _____ → _____
2. _____ → _____
3. _____ → _____

MY GAME RECAP

In your own words, what did you practice on this page?



Applied Passage 1 Summary

COACH'S SCRIPT

Now summarize the passage you just read using SWBST (for the story) or the 5 Ws (for facts). A strong summary captures the big picture in just a sentence or two.

SUMMARIZE WITH SWBST

Somebody: _____

Wanted: _____

But: _____

So: _____

Then: _____

MY ONE-SENTENCE SUMMARY

MY GAME RECAP

What was the trickiest part, and how did you work through it?

**COACH'S SCRIPT**

This applied passage brings it all together. This time, hunt for word-parts: use your Section 2 prefix, suffix, and root skills to break down the big words. Then read the passage smoothly, like a storyteller. You will summarize it on the next page.

THE AMAZING MIGRATION

Every autumn, millions of monarch butterflies begin an incredible journey. These delicate insects travel thousands of miles from Canada and the United States all the way to the mountains of Mexico. Remarkably, no single butterfly completes the entire trip — it takes several generations. Scientists are still discovering how these tiny travelers navigate such enormous distances without ever getting lost. Their migration is one of nature's most astonishing achievements.

MORPHOLOGY HUNT

Use your Section 2 skills! Find a word in the passage for each clue, then break it into its word-parts.

1. A word with the prefix **in-** or **re-**: _____ = _____
2. A word with the suffix **-tion** or **-ly**: _____ = _____
3. A word with the suffix **-ment** or **-ing**: _____ = _____

Hint: scan for words like *incredible*, *generations*, *remarkably*, *discovering*, *achievements*.

MY GAME RECAP

Explain today's skill to your Coach as if they were a teammate:



Applied Passage 2 Summary

COACH'S SCRIPT

Summarize this nonfiction passage with the 5 Ws. Remind your All-Star that a good summary answers only the most important questions — not every detail.

SUMMARIZE WITH THE 5 Ws

Who: _____

What: _____

When: _____

Where: _____

Why: _____

MY ONE-SENTENCE SUMMARY

MY GAME RECAP

Give one example of how you could use this skill in a real book:

**COACH'S SCRIPT**

This applied passage brings it all together. After reading, focus on **prosody** — reading with feeling and emphasis. Find the most exciting sentence and practice reading it like a storyteller. You will summarize it on the next page.

THE INVENTION OF BASKETBALL

In December 1891, a physical education teacher named James Naismith faced a problem. His students were restless and bored during the cold winter months indoors. He needed an exciting new game. Naismith nailed a peach basket to the gymnasium wall and wrote thirteen simple rules. The very first basketball game was played that day. Naismith could never have imagined that his winter activity would grow into one of the most popular sports on the entire planet.

PROSODY CHALLENGE

Now read like a storyteller! Reading with feeling is called **prosody**.

1. Underline the **one sentence** in the passage that you would read with the most excitement or emotion.
2. Why did you choose it? _____
3. Read that sentence aloud two ways — flat like a robot, then with feeling. Which sounds better?

4. Find one word you would say **louder** to show it matters: _____

MY GAME RECAP

What is one thing you understand now that you did not before?



Applied Passage 3 Summary

COACH'S SCRIPT

Summarize this nonfiction passage with the 5 Ws. Remind your All-Star that a good summary answers only the most important questions — not every detail.

SUMMARIZE WITH THE 5 Ws

Who: _____

What: _____

When: _____

Where: _____

Why: _____

MY ONE-SENTENCE SUMMARY

MY GAME RECAP

Write one question you still have about this skill:

**COACH'S SCRIPT**

The final applied passage — the championship moment! Use every tool in your playbook: decode the big words, read smoothly, and think deeply. Then complete the reflection to celebrate how far you have come.

THE FINISH LINE

When Amara started training for the marathon, twenty-six miles seemed impossible. She could barely run two miles without stopping. But she refused to give up on her goal. Following a careful plan, she added a little distance each week. Some mornings were freezing, and her muscles ached, but she remembered why she had started. On race day, surrounded by thousands of determined runners, Amara crossed the finish line with tears of joy. She had transformed an impossible dream into an unforgettable accomplishment.

CHAMPIONSHIP REFLECTION

You used the whole playbook to read that! Answer:

1. One big word you decoded: _____
2. The main idea in one sentence: _____

MY GAME RECAP

Rate this page 1-5 stars and tell why:



Glossary of Terms (A–M)

COACH'S SCRIPT

Use this glossary together whenever your All-Star meets a term they have forgotten. Reviewing these words keeps the whole playbook fresh.

READING TERMS A–M

All-Star	The reader — that's you! The hero of this playbook.
Coach	The parent, tutor, or guide reading alongside the All-Star.
CLOVER	The six syllable types: Closed, Open, Vowel Team, R-Controlled, Consonant-LE, Silent E.
Consonant-LE	A syllable type ending in a consonant + le, like in <i>ta-ble</i> .
Decode	To sound out and read a word using letter-sound patterns.
Detail	A small fact that supports the main idea.
Fluency	Reading smoothly, accurately, and with expression.
Inference	A smart guess using text clues plus what you already know.
Main Idea	The most important point of a paragraph or passage.
Morphology	The study of word parts: prefixes, roots, and suffixes.



Glossary of Terms (N–Z)

COACH'S SCRIPT

The second half of the glossary. Keep these terms handy — they name every skill in the playbook.

READING TERMS N–Z

Myelin	The brain coating that makes practiced skills faster and smoother.
Pause-Prompt-Praise	The 3-step coaching method: Pause 5 seconds, Prompt with a hint, then Praise exactly what the reader did right.
Prefix	A word part added to the front of a root (un–, re–, dis–).
Prosody	Reading with expression — the music of the voice.
Root	The core part of a word that carries its main meaning.
Suffix	A word part added to the end of a root (–ful, –less, –ment).
SWBST	A story summary: Somebody-Wanted-But-So-Then.
Syllable	A word part with one vowel sound, like <i>bas-ket-ball</i> .
Visualize	To make a mental movie of what you read.
Vowel Team	Two vowels working together to make one sound (ai, ea, oa).

**COACH'S SCRIPT**

Use this key to check answers together. Many pages ask for open responses (write-your-own, summaries, reflections), so accept any reasonable answer for those. The answers below cover the items with one correct response.

SELECTED ANSWERS

- p8** Short: strand, plop, crop, twitch, grasp · Long: gleam, stripe, throat, blaze, sweet
- p9** Short: snap, split, print, stuck · Long: flame, slide, drove, broke
- p10** map-S, rake-L, sit-S, mice-L, cup-S, tune-L · Bonus: cake, pin
- p11** cap-C, make-E, train-O, bird-R · Bonus: Silent E, R-Controlled
- p12** dog-Closed, face-Silent E, patio-Open, car-R-Controlled, table-Consonant-LE, boat-Vowel Team
- p13** tree-Vowel Team, smile-Silent E, tumble-Consonant-LE, spell-Closed · Bonus: rain, cake
- p14** cat-Closed, me-Open, rain-Vowel Team, dark-R-Controlled, simple-Consonant-LE, hope-Silent E
- p16** rain-ai, beach-ea, cloud-ou, toast-oa, moon-oo · Bonus: oa, ea
- p17** car-ar, turn-ur, corn-or, bird-ir · Bonus: T, F (corn=or)
- p18** mail-Team, shirt-R, boat-Team, star-R
- p19** bot-tle, trou-ble, puz-zle, mar-ble · Bonus: happy
- p20** able-Y, maple-Y, blue-N, needle-Y, uncle-Y, little-Y · Bonus: ta-ble, bun-dle
- p21** bas-ket, rab-bit, sud-den, mag-net, con-test
- p22** ble · lit-tle · jun-ple · (b) purple
- p23** bas-ket-ball, won-der-ful, di-no-saur, com-pu-ter, ad-ven-ture, im-por-tant
- p24** tornado, garden, dog, pumpkin, sit
- p25** in-for-ma-tion, es-pe-cial-ly, in-vis-i-ble, wa-ter-mel-on, cel-e-bra-tion, hel-i-cop-ter · Bonus: basketball
- p26** Bonus: R/N/R, N/R/N
- p27** rocket-2, butterfly-3, calculator-4, magnet-2, community-4, champion-3
- p28** Vowel Team (oa) · fan-tas-tic · (b) bird · four
- p30** rebuilding=re+build+ing · unkindly=un+kind+ly · helpful=help+ful
- p31** unlock, rewrite, unfair, refill
- p32** disobey-B, preheat-A, dishonest-D, pretest-C
- p33** miscount, misplace, mislead (all = done wrong)
- p35** unlock, rebuild, preview, misplace, disappear
- p36** un/dis=not, re=again, pre=before, mis=wrong · roots: friendly, school, appear, write
- p37** joyful, fearless, colorful, useless
- p38** quietly, bravely, invention, subtraction
- p39** amazement, treatment, improvement, statement
- p40** painter, protection, enjoyment
- p41** directions, cheerfully, waterless, improvement, kindly
- p42** thankful, helpless, safely, excitement
- p44** spectators, inspect, inspector
- p45** construct-B, structure-C, instructor-A · instructor builds knowledge
- p46** predict-dict (say), transport-port (carry), dictionary-dict (say)
- p47** tri-B, port-C, aqua-A, dict-D
- p48** P: re, dis, pre · S: -ful, -ment, -ly · R: spect, struct
- p55** When the whistle blew / the players sprinted down the court / ready to give their very best.
- p76** 1. M 2. T 3. D 4. M
- p88** Visualizing-B, Main Idea-A, Inferencing-D, SWBST-C
- Word Search** pp14,18,22,28,42,48: every listed word appears across, down, or diagonally (self-check).
- p43/97** A tricycle has three wheels (tri = three).

THE READING PLAYBOOK

CERTIFICATE OF ACHIEVEMENT

This certifies that

has completed all 100 pages of **The Reading Playbook** and is now an official **All-Star Reader**. Through hard work, daily practice, and true grit, this reader has built stronger phonics, vocabulary, fluency, and comprehension skills — and a faster, stronger brain to match. Play ball!

All-Star Signature_____
Coach Signature

Date completed: _____

